December 2026 · Grades K–2

Classroom Elf Calendar

16 fun, low-prep Elf on the Shelf ideas for every school day,
Tuesday, Dec 1 – Tuesday, Dec 22, plus 18 printables



What's inside

- **Page 2:** Monday–Friday calendar with a different idea every day
- **Pages 3–4:** Teacher guide: how to set up each scene, plus what you'll need
- **Pages 5–22:** Printables 1–18, numbered to match the calendar

Quick tips

- Set up each scene after school the day before, so it's ready first thing.
- Check for food allergies before any snack idea (Dec 3, Dec 8, Dec 14).
- Did someone touch the elf? Sprinkle a little cinnamon "magic" nearby and the elf is good as new!
- Not every family celebrates. Keep it light and playful, and welcome everyone to join the fun.

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December 2026

Classroom Elf Calendar · Monday–Friday



Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
30 Nov 30 Get ready! The elf arrives tomorrow.	1 **The Elf Arrives!** The elf flies in with a welcome letter. Read it together and learn the "no touching" rule. Printable 1	2 **Name Our Elf** The elf sits on a ballot box. Everyone votes on its name! Printables 2 & 3	3 **Snowball Fight!** A marshmallow snowball fight behind a paper-cup fort. Count the snowballs! Printable 4	4 **Zip Line Adventure** The elf zips across the room on a string. Draw where it will fly next. Printable 5
7 **Wrapping Paper Mischief** The elf wrapped the teacher's things in wrapping paper! File a Mischief Report. Printable 6	8 **Gone Fishing** The elf goes fishing in a bowl of fish crackers. Everyone earns a fishing license! Printable 7	9 **Elf Art Studio** The elf is caught coloring, with crayons everywhere. Color your own elf! Printable 8	10 **Hide & Seek Hunt** The elf hides and leaves clues. Follow the scavenger hunt to find it! Printable 9	11 **Snow Angel** A snow angel in powdered sugar! Play Roll & Build a Snowman. Printable 10
14 **Elf Movie Morning** The elf has popcorn and movie tickets ready. Enjoy a short holiday cartoon. Printable 11	15 **Story Time with Stuffies** The elf reads to the stuffed animals. Everyone gets an elf bookmark. Printable 12	16 **North Pole Mail** The elf brings a North Pole mailbox. Write letters to Santa. Printable 13	17 **Elf Friends Visit** Paper elf friends are hiding all over the room. Find all 15! Printable 14	18 **Cocoa Bath** The elf soaks in a mug of cotton-ball "marshmallows" and sends home PJ Day invites. Printable 15
21 **PJ Day Photo Booth** PJ Day! The elf is in pajamas, with a photo booth. Say "cheese!" Printable 16	22 **Goodbye, Elf!** The elf says goodbye with a letter and Nice List certificates. Printables 17 & 18	**Dec 23–25: Winter Break!** The elf is back at the North Pole helping Santa.		

Teacher Guide Week 1 & Week 2

Tue 1 Dec

The Elf Arrives! Printable 1

Set the scene: Sit the elf on a stack of books near the board, holding the Welcome Letter. Sprinkle cotton balls or paper "snow" around it.
Morning fun: Read the letter aloud. Teach the big rule: you can look and talk, but don't touch. It keeps the elf's magic!
You'll need: The elf, cotton balls or white paper scraps

Wed 2 Dec

Name Our Elf Printables 2 & 3

Set the scene: Cut a slot in a tissue box, label it "Ballot Box," and sit the elf on top with the blank ballots beside it.
Morning fun: Each child writes or draws a name idea. Pick the top 3 and vote with a show of hands. Fill in the "Meet Our Elf" sign.
You'll need: Tissue box, pencils

Thu 3 Dec

Snowball Fight! Printable 4

Set the scene: Build a small fort of paper cups. Put the elf behind it, a stuffed animal "opponent" across the desk, and scatter mini marshmallows.
Morning fun: Who won? Count the "snowballs" together, then do the counting page.
You'll need: Paper cups, mini marshmallows or cotton balls, a stuffed animal

Fri 4 Dec

Zip Line Adventure Printable 5

Set the scene: Tie yarn from a high spot to a lower one (e.g., a cabinet to a chair). Hang the elf from it with a binder clip or a paper-cup "gondola."
Morning fun: Talk about where the elf might zip next, then draw it.
You'll need: Yarn or string, a binder clip or paper cup

Mon 7 Dec

Wrapping Paper Mischief Printable 6

Set the scene: Wrap a few desk items (stapler, tape, a mug, your chair) in holiday wrapping paper. Leave the elf on top with tape stuck to its hand.
Morning fun: Let students help unwrap. Then they fill out a Mischief Report about what they think happened.
You'll need: Wrapping paper or newspaper, tape

Tue 8 Dec

Gone Fishing Printable 7

Set the scene: Make a fishing pole from a pencil, string, and a paperclip hook. Sit the elf on the edge of a bowl of fish-shaped crackers.
Morning fun: Share the "catch" at snack time (check for allergies first). Hand out fishing licenses to fill in.
You'll need: Pencil, string, paperclip, bowl, fish crackers

Wed 9 Dec

Elf Art Studio Printable 8

Set the scene: Leave the elf lying on a half-colored page, surrounded by crayons, with one silly scribble on the whiteboard.
Morning fun: Free coloring time. Hang finished pages as an "Elf Art Gallery."
You'll need: Crayons

Thu 10 Dec

Hide & Seek Hunt Printable 9

Set the scene: Hide the elf in a final spot. Tape Clue 1 to the board and the other clues at each spot (door, library, sink, cubbies, pencil sharpener).
Morning fun: Read each clue together and walk to the next spot until you find the elf. Swap spots to fit your room.
You'll need: Tape

Teacher Guide Week 3 & Week 4

Fri 11 Dec

Snow Angel — Printable 10

Set the scene: Spread a thin layer of flour or powdered sugar on a dark tray or black paper. Press the elf in to make a "snow angel" and leave it lying there.
Morning fun: Play Roll & Build a Snowman with a partner or in small groups.
You'll need: Dark tray or black paper, flour or powdered sugar, dice

Mon 14 Dec

Elf Movie Morning — Printable 11

Set the scene: Set the elf in front of the board with a small bag of popcorn and a stack of movie tickets.
Morning fun: Hand out tickets, then watch a short holiday cartoon or read-aloud video (5–15 min) when it fits your day.
You'll need: Popcorn (optional), a short video

Tue 15 Dec

Story Time with Stuffies — Printable 12

Set the scene: Set the elf in the reading corner holding an open book, with stuffed animals sitting in a circle "listening."
Morning fun: Give everyone a bookmark to color. Do buddy reading or read a holiday story aloud.
You'll need: A picture book, a few stuffed animals

Wed 16 Dec

North Pole Mail — Printable 13

Set the scene: Label a shoebox "North Pole Mail" and sit the elf on top.
Morning fun: Kids write or draw a letter to Santa and "mail" it. The elf takes the letters to the North Pole tonight!
You'll need: Shoebox, marker

Thu 17 Dec

Elf Friends Visit — Printable 14

Set the scene: Cut out the mini paper elves and hide them around the room: on shelves, under chairs, in plants. The real elf holds the sign.
Morning fun: Find all 15 friends, counting them together as they turn up.
You'll need: Scissors, tape

Fri 18 Dec

Cocoa Bath — Printable 15

Set the scene: Put the elf in a big mug filled with cotton balls ("marshmallows"), with the PJ Day invitations stacked beside it.
Morning fun: Read the invitation together and send it home for Monday's PJ Day. (Check your school's dress policy.)
You'll need: Large mug, cotton balls

Mon 21 Dec

PJ Day Photo Booth — Printable 16

Set the scene: Dress the elf in pajamas (a sock "sleeping bag" or a tissue "blanket" works) next to the photo booth props.
Morning fun: Kids pose with the props for class photos (follow your school's photo policy).
You'll need: Craft sticks, tape, a phone or camera

Tue 22 Dec

Goodbye, Elf! — Printables 17 & 18

Set the scene: Sit the elf in its very first spot with the Goodbye Letter and a stack of certificates (plus candy canes, if you like).
Morning fun: Read the letter, hand out certificates, and wave goodbye as the elf "flies home" tonight.
You'll need: Candy canes (optional)



Hello from the North Pole!

Dear Friends,

Santa sent me to your classroom to spend December with you! Every night I fly back to the North Pole to tell Santa about all the kind and helpful things I see.

I have one very important rule: **please do not touch me!** If you touch me, I might lose my Christmas magic. But you can talk to me anytime. I'm a great listener!

Every school morning, look for me. I'll be hiding somewhere new, and I might bring a surprise!

Oh, and one more thing... I don't have a name yet! Can you help me think of one?

Your new friend,

Your Classroom Elf

Name Our Elf!

Cut apart. Write or draw your best elf name, then drop it in the ballot box.

Name the Elf Ballot



I think our elf should be named:

_____

_____

Voter:

_____

Name the Elf Ballot



I think our elf should be named:

_____

_____

Voter:

_____

Name the Elf Ballot



I think our elf should be named:

_____

_____

Voter:

_____

Name the Elf Ballot



I think our elf should be named:

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Voter:

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Name the Elf Ballot



I think our elf should be named:

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Name the Elf Ballot



I think our elf should be named:

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Voter:

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Name the Elf Ballot



I think our elf should be named:

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Voter:

_____

Name the Elf Ballot



I think our elf should be named:

_____

_____

Voter:

_____

Meet Our Elf!



My name is _____

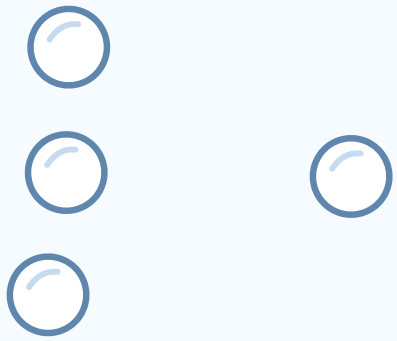
I arrived on December 1, 2026

I live at The North Pole

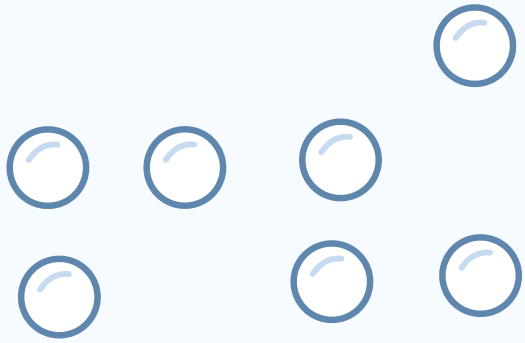
Please look, but don't touch!

Count the Snowballs!

The elf had a snowball fight! Count the snowballs in each box and write the number.



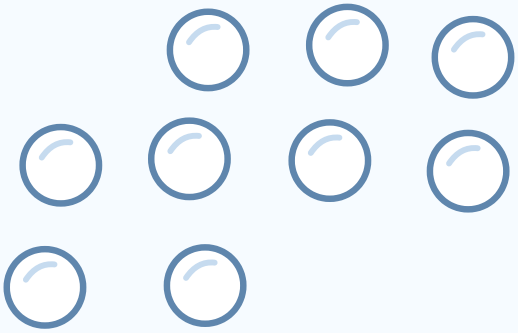
There are ☐ snowballs.



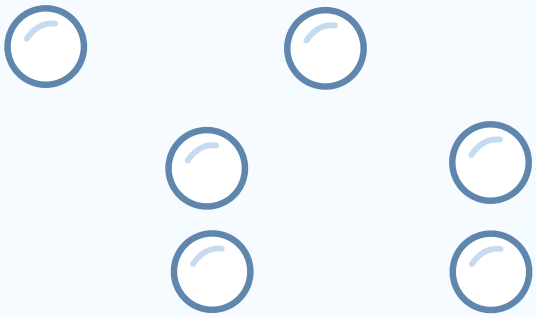
There are ☐ snowballs.



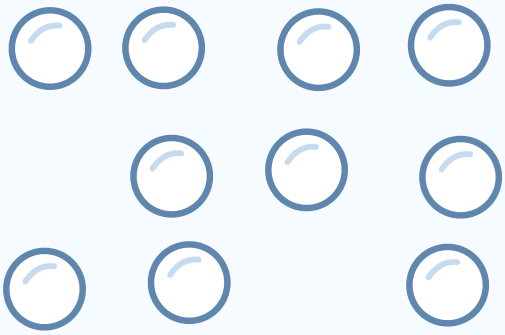
There are ☐ snowballs.



There are ☐ snowballs.



There are ☐ snowballs.



There are ☐ snowballs.



Bonus: Which box has the most snowballs? Color it in!

Where Will I Zip Next?

Draw where you think the elf will zip to next!



I think the elf will zip to _____

Name: _____

Elf Mischief Report

CASE FILE

Reporter: _____ Date: December _____, 2026

1. Draw what the elf did:

2. Was the elf... (circle one)

Naughty **Silly** **BOTH!**

3. Why do you think the elf did it?



Case closed! Thank you, Detective.

Gone Fishing!

Cut out your license. Fill it in and draw your picture.

OFFICIAL North Pole Fishing License

Draw yourself here!

Name: _____

Favorite fish: _____

Fish I can catch:

Issued: December 8, 2026

Approved by: the Classroom Elf

OFFICIAL North Pole Fishing License

Draw yourself here!

Name: _____

Favorite fish: _____

Fish I can catch:

Issued: December 8, 2026

Approved by: the Classroom Elf

Our Classroom Elf



Colored by: _____

Elf Hide & Seek Hunt

Cut apart. The small gray note on each card says where to put it. Change spots to fit your room!

1

Clue 1

Hello, friends! Let's play a game.
Go where we line up... I'll do the same!

Teacher: Tape to the board

2

Clue 2

Books and stories, big and small.
Look where we read. I'm near them all!

Teacher: Place at the door

3

Clue 3

Wash your hands, scrub, scrub, scrub!
Check by the sink, rub-a-dub-dub!

Teacher: Place in the library

4

Clue 4

Where do you put your things each day?
Peek by the cubbies, hip hooray!

Teacher: Place by the sink

5

Clue 5

Pencils sharp and ready to go.
Look by the sharpener down below!

Teacher: Place by the cubbies



You found me!

Hooray, hooray, you found my chair!
Thanks for playing, I was hiding there!

Teacher: Place with the elf

Roll & Build a Snowman

Take turns rolling a die. Draw the part that matches your roll. Start with a 1! First to finish the whole snowman wins.



Big bottom snowball



Middle snowball



Small head



Top hat



Eyes & carrot nose



Stick arms & scarf

Build your snowman here!

Name: _____

Elf Cinema Tickets

Cut apart and hand one to every movie-goer!

ADMIT ONE

ELF CINEMA

Now showing: a holiday surprise!

Seat: _____ Popcorn: Yes / No



ADMIT ONE

ELF CINEMA

Now showing: a holiday surprise!

Seat: _____ Popcorn: Yes / No



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Now showing: a holiday surprise!

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ELF CINEMA

Now showing: a holiday surprise!

Seat: _____ Popcorn: Yes / No



ADMIT ONE

ELF CINEMA

Now showing: a holiday surprise!

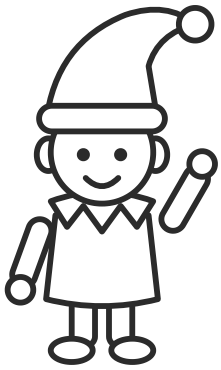
Seat: _____ Popcorn: Yes / No



Elf Bookmarks

Color, cut out, and use with your favorite book!

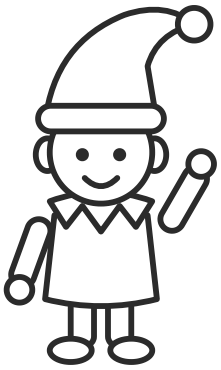
Snow much fun to read!



❄ ❄

Name: _____

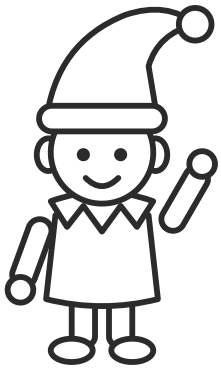
Shhh... the elf is reading!



❄ ❄

Name: _____

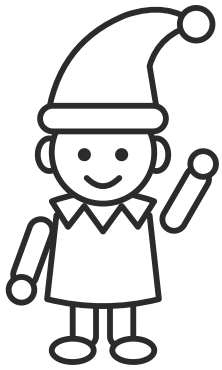
I read with our elf!



❄ ❄

Name: _____

Elf-ishly good reader!



❄ ❄

Name: _____



North Pole Mail

Dear Santa,

This year I was kind when I

My favorite thing about December is

I would love

Here is a picture for you:

Love,

Mini Elf Friends

Cut out the 15 elf friends and hide them around the room. Give the sign to your real elf to hold!

















My friends are hiding!
Can you find all 15?

PJ Day Invitations

Cut apart and send one home with each student.

You're Invited!

PJ Day

Monday, December 21, 2026

Wear your coziest pajamas to school! Bring your best smile for our elf photo booth.

Love, your Classroom Elf



You're Invited!

PJ Day

Monday, December 21, 2026

Wear your coziest pajamas to school! Bring your best smile for our elf photo booth.

Love, your Classroom Elf



You're Invited!

PJ Day

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Wear your coziest pajamas to school! Bring your best smile for our elf photo booth.

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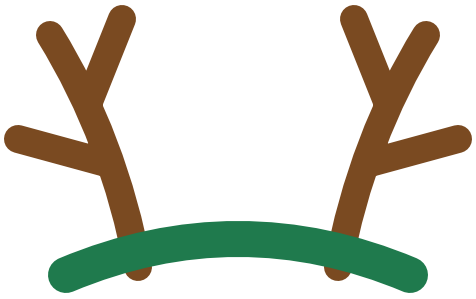


Elf Photo Booth Props

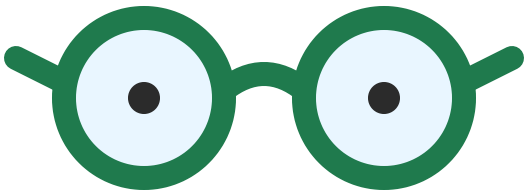
Cut out each prop and tape it to a craft stick. Strike a pose!



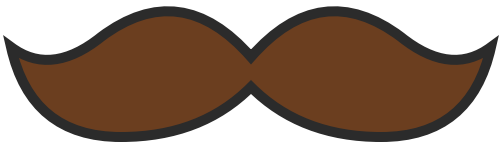
Elf Hat



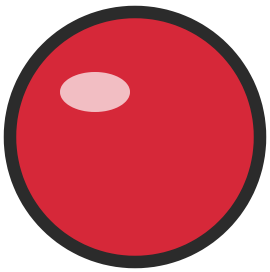
Reindeer Antlers



Silly Glasses



Fancy Mustache



Rudolph Nose



Nice List Sign



Goodbye for Now!

Dear Friends,

Today is my last day in your classroom. Tonight I'm flying home to the North Pole to help Santa get ready for the big night!

I had SO much fun with you: snowball fights, fishing, zip lining, story time, and our PJ Day photo booth!

I told Santa how kind, helpful, and silly you all are. You made my heart as warm as a cup of hot cocoa.

Have a wonderful winter break. Be kind, read lots of books, and get plenty of rest.

I'll miss you! See you next year!

Love,

_____

OFFICIAL

Nice List Certificate

This certifies that

_____

was spotted being **kind**, **helpful**, and full of **holiday cheer**
by our Classroom Elf and is officially on the Nice List!

Santa Claus	December 22, 2026	
North Pole	Date	Teacher



